

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Criminal Complaint and Supporting Affidavit

**United States District Court for the Middle District of North Carolina United States v.
Mateo Serrano** Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 Docket Entry 1 Filed
November 3, 2025

Kellan Rhys, a fictional investigator with the Synthetic Federal Program Integrity Office, submits this complaint and affidavit solely for a training record. Rhys alleges probable cause to believe that Mateo Serrano knowingly participated in a conspiracy to commit wire fraud, in violation of 18 U.S.C. §§ 1349 and 1343, between August 4 and November 2, 2025.

The alleged object was to obtain reimbursement payments from fictional Meridian Community Supply Cooperative through materially false claims that eligible services had been performed. The complaint states the legal theory and safe factual categories only. It does not reproduce a claim form, transmission method, credential, account route, review weakness, concealment step, or private identifier.

The charged people and organization are fictional. The assertions are allegations, not findings. Serrano retains the presumption of innocence and every right afforded to an accused person unless he later enters a valid plea or is convicted after trial.

Affiant and Investigative Scope

Rhys is assigned to the Synthetic Federal Program Integrity Office, an invented agency used to present neutral evidentiary categories. In this exercise, Rhys is authorized to review ordinary cooperative records, interview fictional witnesses, and compare reimbursement representations with records showing whether the described services occurred.

The investigation did not involve a real government system, financial account, business, or person. Any reference to a record means a purpose-built fictional exhibit. No protected database, interception technique, access credential, or surveillance method is described. The affidavit relies on summaries suitable for a public probable-cause filing.

Rhys reviewed records attributed to Meridian Community Supply Cooperative, statements from its fictional custodians, communications voluntarily produced by participants, and admissions made during noncustodial interviews. Those sources allegedly show a shared agreement and Serrano's knowing participation. The affidavit distinguishes direct evidence from inference and does not claim that every participant held the same relative role. Probable cause to charge membership does not decide a later advisory sentencing adjustment.

Fictional Cooperative and Alleged False Claims

Meridian Community Supply Cooperative administered a fictional reimbursement program for approved community-service vendors. A qualifying claim represented that specified services had been completed and met the cooperative's basic eligibility rules. The investigation allegedly identified claims seeking payment for services that had not occurred.

The complaint omits all operational mechanics. It does not say how a claimant enrolled, how a submission was prepared, what fields were reviewed, how payment moved, or how a system responded. Those details are unnecessary to the allegation that statements about completed services were materially false and capable of influencing reimbursement decisions.

Rhys alleges that participants knew the services had not been performed when the claims were presented. The cooperative released funds during the charged period in reliance on the representations. The aggregate amount attributed to the agreement was \$186,400. That amount remains subject to proof at this charging stage. It identifies no real victim loss and supplies no usable financial information.

Charged Period and Interstate Nexus

The alleged conspiracy began by August 4, 2025, and continued through November 2, 2025. Rhys identifies November 2 as the final date on which a participant acted to advance the agreement. Conduct after that date concerns investigation and procedure rather than an additional charged offense act.

At least one communication in furtherance of the agreement crossed state lines through an ordinary commercial wire service. The precise route, endpoint, format, authentication, and content are intentionally omitted. For probable-cause purposes, fictional records allegedly show that interstate use was foreseeable to participants, including Serrano.

The wire allegation does not depend on Serrano personally transmitting every communication. The government alleges that he knowingly joined the common plan and intended its fraudulent object. Whether the evidence ultimately proves those elements beyond a reasonable doubt remains for later proceedings. The completion date also may bear on the Sentencing Guidelines Manual if a conviction occurs, but this complaint makes no calculation or sentencing recommendation.

Five Alleged Participants

The investigation identified exactly five allegedly criminally responsible participants: Mateo Serrano, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt. Each name is fabricated. No cooperative employee acting innocently, investigator, witness, or service recipient is included in that count.

Rhys alleges that the five people shared awareness of the false-claim objective and performed different tasks in support of it. The affidavit intentionally avoids describing those tasks in a sequence that could function as instruction. It alleges Serrano communicated with other members and knowingly aided the plan.

The complaint does not allege as an element that Serrano led, organized, managed, or supervised another participant. Relative role is unnecessary to probable cause for the conspiracy charge and would require a distinct evidentiary evaluation if sentencing later occurs. In particular, this filing does not resolve whether Serrano's interactions with Pared reflected authority over her or coordination between equals. That issue remains outside the charging determination.

Evidence Categories Supporting Probable Cause

Rhys relies on four safe categories of fictional evidence. First, cooperative records allegedly show that reimbursement representations did not match service records. Second, witness statements describe participants' knowledge that the services were absent. Third, participant communications show awareness of the shared objective without revealing how a claim was technically submitted. Fourth, Serrano's own statements allegedly acknowledge knowing involvement.

The sources are mutually corroborative at the category level. A custodian can authenticate the cooperative records. Witness accounts are compared with contemporaneous fictional documents. Communications are described by subject rather than reproduced. Serrano's statements are included only to the extent voluntary and lawfully obtained in this constructed record.

This affidavit does not ask the court to decide credibility beyond the probable-cause standard. It does not establish a loss amount for sentencing, a participant's relative role, restitution, or guilt beyond a reasonable doubt. Those questions require later process. The categorical presentation protects the exercise from becoming a guide to fraud or a repository of private information.

Materiality, Intent, and Agreement

The reimbursement representations were allegedly material because whether services had been performed was capable of influencing the cooperative's decision to pay. Participants allegedly understood that relationship. The complaint does not rely on a harmless error, ambiguous description, or innocent misunderstanding.

Rhys alleges an agreement from coordinated statements and conduct across the charged period. Serrano allegedly knew the essential unlawful object and chose to participate. His presence or association alone would not be sufficient; the asserted evidence instead supports an inference of intentional membership. The complaint does not claim that the conspirators documented a formal agreement.

Fraudulent intent is inferred from the alleged knowledge that services were not performed, the repeated pursuit of reimbursement, and communications acknowledging the mismatch. The affidavit provides only that legal and factual summary. It excludes tactics for bypassing review, disguising activity, or moving funds. On these alleged facts, Rhys submits that probable cause exists for the charged conspiracy and its wire-fraud object.

Request and Attestation

Rhys requests issuance of process requiring Serrano to appear and answer Count One. The government does not seek a merits ruling through this complaint. Any custody determination must be made separately under the governing law and an individualized record. No allegation here eliminates the presumption of innocence.

Rhys affirms that the complaint concerns synthetic people and events, and that every evidentiary description has been abstracted to avoid operational crime detail. The named cooperative is fictional, the monetary amount is an exercise value, and no source points to a real account or institution. The affidavit is true to the best of the affiant's knowledge within that fictional record.

Magistrate Judge Mira Lorne reviewed the sworn allegations on November 3, 2025. Finding probable cause for Count One, the court authorized the requested process. That finding addresses only whether the charge may proceed. It does not determine guilt, sentencing facts, an appeal waiver, or any later procedural issue.

Kellan Rhys Fictional Investigative Affiant

Sworn before **Mira Lorne**, Fictional United States Magistrate Judge, on November 3, 2025.